



TARGET CAT 2025



FASTRACK 2025

VARC

**TONE AND STRUCTURE
QUESTIONS**

Lecture 07

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RECAP

of previous lecture



- 1) Main Idea and Primary Purpose Questions
- 2) Practice Passage
- 3) Practice Questions

TOPICS

to be covered



adjectives/adverbs

+ve

-ve

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- 1) Strategies to Solve Tone and Structure Questions
- 2) Practice Passage
- 3) Practice Questions

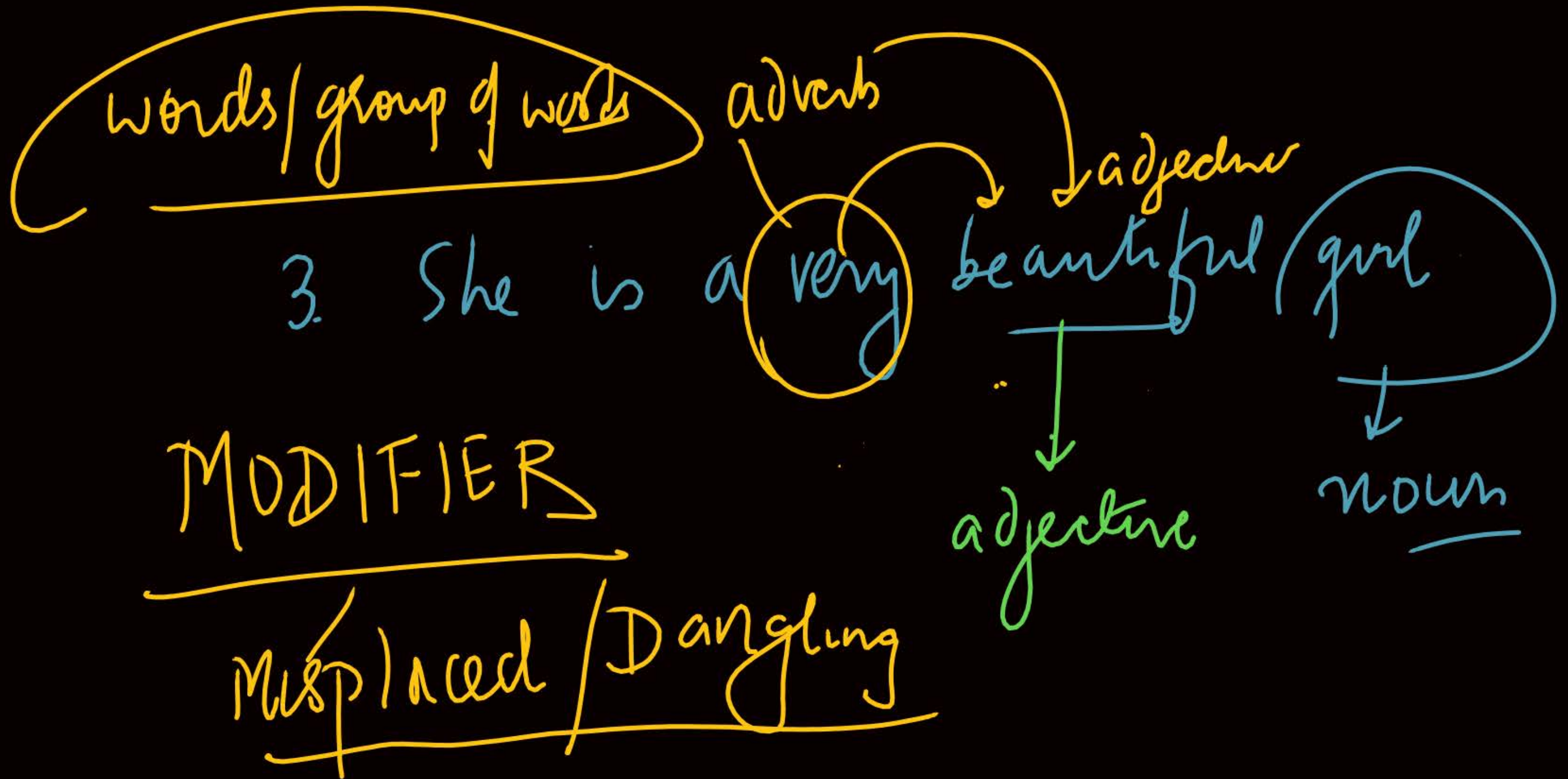


modifiers

adjectives - describing / qualifying
words
nouns, pronouns

My brilliant students

My useless friends





Topic : Strategies to Solve Tone & Structure Questions



- ✓ The tone of any given passage is the author's emotion or feeling, usually towards his subject.
- ✓ An author's style is the particular way he uses language to reflect his unique authorial voice. Most style or tone questions will include the words "attitude," "tone," "style," "feeling," etc.



Topic : Strategies to Solve Tone & Structure Questions



A typical question of this type might look like this :

- ✓ The author's attitude toward global warming might best be described as which of the following?
- ✓ Which of the following best describes the tone of the passage? *Opinion*
- ✓ Based on the statements in lines 43-46, which of the following could be inferred about the author's attitude toward socialism?



Topic : Strategies to Solve Tone & Structure Questions



- ✓ The best way to identify the tone of a passage is to examine certain words with positive or negative connotations.
- ✓ If I were writing a passage about global warming, and one sentence read "fortunately, these brilliant scientists were able to combine their wits and begin formulating promising solutions," you should identify my tone as positive, optimistic, or reverent.

Types of Questions
Lecture 2

✓ extol +ve
admonish
castigating -ve
condemning

→ connotation
Vocab



Topic : Strategies to Solve Tone & Structure Questions



- ✓ I respect and honor the scientists, and I consider their research valuable and intelligent. Of course, we can imagine that an author adopt a negative tone toward the same subject.
- ✓ Another author might say that "the irresponsible scientists pooled together their half-baked theories to create the most egregious scare tactic of the 21st century." Notice that positively or negatively charged word in italics – they are the keys to identifying tone.

–ve



Topic : How to Deal with Tone and Structure Questions in CAT VARC



Tone and structure-based questions in CAT VARC (Verbal Ability & Reading Comprehension) test your ability to understand the author's intent, writing style, and the logical flow of the passage. Here's how you can tackle them effectively :

1. **Dealing with Tone-Based Questions :**

These questions ask you to determine the author's attitude or emotion towards the topic.

Step-by-Step Approach :

- ✓ **Identify Emotion Keywords :** Look for words that indicate emotions, such as admiration (laudatory), criticism (critical), doubt (cynical), or irony (sarcastic).
- ✓ **Check for Word Choice & Language :** Does the author use neutral, positive, or negative words?

Example : "The reforms are well-intentioned but impractical" suggests a critical tone.

judgemental →

- ✓ **Understand the Overall Intent** : Is the passage explaining (expository), analyzing (analytical), narrating a story (narrative), or vividly describing something (descriptive)?
- ✓ **Eliminate Extreme Options** : If a passage is slightly critical, an extreme tone like “hostile” or “scathing” is unlikely.

Question -



#Q. Passage Excerpt : "The policy, though promising, suffers from vague execution plans, making it another case of ambitious but unrealistic governance."

What is the author's tone?

A. Optimistic

B. Laudatory

C. Critical

D. Neutral

Opinion



Answer :

(C) Critical (because the passage highlights a flaw in execution).

Final Tips to Ace Tone & Structure Questions in CAT VARC :

- ✓ Practice identifying tones from editorials, news articles, and opinion pieces.
- ✓ Summarize passages in your own words to understand their structure.
- ✓ Use elimination strategy to rule out incorrect options.
- ✓ Develop a habit of recognizing transition words to track logical flow.

analysis

Analytical Tone – Explanation :

An analytical tone is used when an author examines a topic logically, breaking it down into different components and evaluating them systematically. This tone is objective, structured, and often backed by data, reasoning, and comparisons. It is commonly found in essays, reports, and academic discussions.

Opinion

Sample Passage :

The rapid rise of artificial intelligence (AI) ^{✓ a ganda} in various industries has sparked debates regarding its long-term implications. On one hand, AI enhances efficiency by automating repetitive tasks, thereby increasing productivity and reducing human error. ^{+ve} For instance, in the healthcare sector, AI-powered diagnostics have significantly improved early disease detection rates. ^{-ve} On the other hand, widespread automation raises concerns about job displacement, particularly in low-skill industries where repetitive tasks are predominant. A report by the World Economic Forum suggests that while AI may eliminate certain jobs, it will also create new roles requiring advanced technical expertise. Thus, the real challenge lies in upskilling the workforce to adapt to this transformation. Additionally, ethical considerations, such as algorithmic bias and data privacy, must be addressed to ensure responsible AI deployment. Therefore, while AI presents promising opportunities, its integration must be managed carefully to balance efficiency with socio-economic stability.

Persuasive Tone – Explanation :

A persuasive tone is used when the author aims to convince the reader to adopt a particular viewpoint, belief, or course of action. This tone often includes strong arguments, rhetorical devices, emotional appeals, and logical reasoning. It is commonly found in opinion pieces, advertisements, speeches, and argumentative essays.

Sample Passage :

Climate change is not a distant threat—it is happening now, and immediate action is essential. Rising global temperatures have led to extreme weather events, devastating communities worldwide. According to NASA, the past decade has been the hottest on record, proving that human activities, particularly fossil fuel consumption, are accelerating global warming. If we do not act swiftly, future generations will inherit an uninhabitable planet. Governments must enforce strict regulations on carbon emissions, and individuals must adopt sustainable practices, such as using renewable energy and reducing plastic waste. Critics argue that economic growth should take precedence over environmental policies, but what good is wealth if the planet itself is at risk? The time for debate is over—we must take responsibility and implement real change before it's too late. Every small effort counts, and together, we can protect our only home.

1. **Descriptive Tone – Explanation :**

A descriptive tone focuses on vividly painting a picture using sensory details—sight, sound, touch, smell, and taste. It helps the reader visualize scenes, emotions, or settings, making them feel immersed in the text. It is commonly used in literature, travel writing, and poetry.

Sample Passage :

The golden sun dipped below the horizon, casting hues of orange and pink across the sky. A soft breeze carried the scent of salt and blooming jasmine as the waves rhythmically kissed the shore. The sand, cool and damp beneath my feet, crunched softly with every step. In the distance, a lighthouse stood tall, its flickering beam slicing through the twilight. Laughter echoed from a nearby bonfire where friends huddled, their faces glowing in the amber light. The air was filled with the crackling of burning wood and the sweet aroma of roasted marshmallows. Everything felt peaceful, like a scene frozen in time.

2. **Narrative Tone – Explanation :**

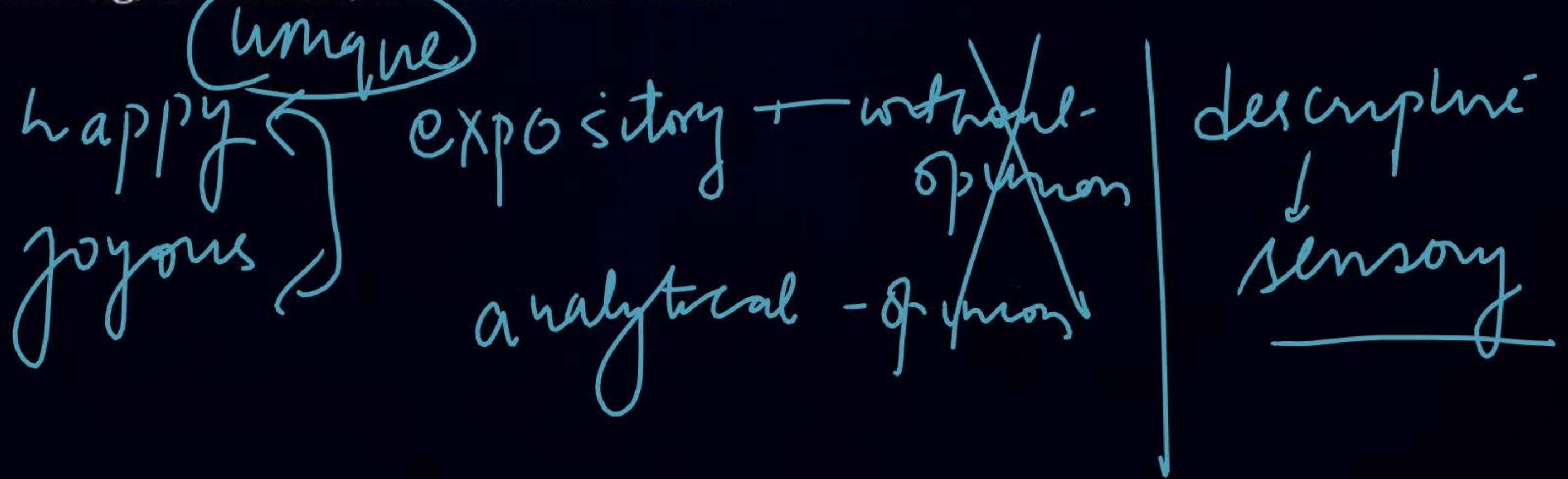
A narrative tone is used to tell a story, often including characters, dialogues, conflicts, and a sequence of events. This tone is engaging and structured like a plot, making the reader feel part of the experience.

Sample Passage :

As the clock struck midnight, Aryan tiptoed through the darkened hallway, his heart pounding like a drum. He knew he shouldn't be sneaking out, but curiosity had gotten the best of him. The old wooden floor creaked under his weight, making him freeze in place. Holding his breath, he listened—silence. He exhaled slowly and pressed on. As he reached for the rusted doorknob, a sudden gust of wind slammed the window shut behind him. His pulse quickened. Was it just the wind, or was someone else awake? Summoning his courage, he twisted the knob and pushed the door open, revealing a dimly lit attic filled with dust-covered antiques. And then, he saw it—a faded diary resting on an old wooden chest. His adventure had just begun.

3. Expository Tone – Explanation :

An expository tone is used to explain, inform, or clarify a topic with facts and logical reasoning. It is objective, straightforward, and found in academic writing, textbooks, and news articles.



Sample Passage :

photosynthesis
 Photosynthesis is the process by which green plants convert sunlight into energy. This occurs in the chloroplasts of plant cells, where chlorophyll absorbs light energy. The process consists of two main stages : the light-dependent reactions and the Calvin cycle. During the light-dependent reactions, sunlight splits water molecules, releasing oxygen and generating energy carriers such as ATP. In the Calvin cycle, carbon dioxide is absorbed from the atmosphere and converted into glucose, which serves as food for the plant. This process is essential not only for plant survival but also for maintaining atmospheric oxygen levels. Without photosynthesis, life on Earth would struggle to sustain itself, as plants form the base of the food chain. Understanding this process helps scientists develop sustainable agricultural practices and address environmental challenges such as deforestation and climate change.

Here's a table comparing Analytical, Descriptive, Narrative, and Expository tones :

Tone	Purpose	Key Features	Commonly Found In	Example Sentence
Analytical	To break down and examine a topic logically.	- Evaluates different aspects of a subject. - Uses reasoning, comparisons, and evidence. - Objective in approach.	Essays, reports, research papers, editorials.	"The rise in global temperatures can be linked to increased carbon emissions, which have significantly impacted weather patterns worldwide."

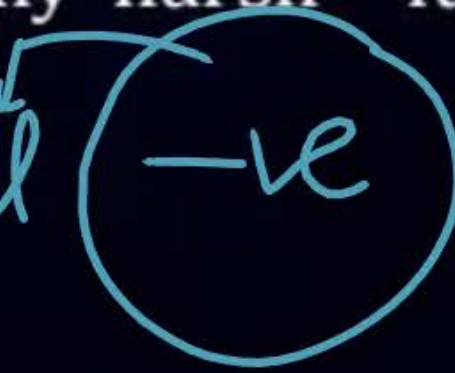
Tone	Purpose	Key Features	Commonly Found In	Example Sentence
Descriptive	To create a vivid picture using sensory details.	- Focuses on sights, sounds, smells, tastes, and textures. - Uses figurative language (similes, metaphors). - Evokes emotions.	Poetry, travel writing, novels, creative essays.	"The sun dipped below the horizon, painting the sky in hues of crimson and gold, while the ocean shimmered under the evening glow."

Tone	Purpose	Key Features	Commonly Found In	Example Sentence
Narrative	To tell a story with characters, events, and emotions.	- Includes a structured plot (beginning, middle, end). - Features dialogues and character development. - Creates engagement through suspense or emotions.	Short stories, novels, autobiographies, personal essays.	"Aryan tiptoed through the dark hallway, his heart racing as the old wooden floor creaked beneath him."

Tone	Purpose	Key Features	Commonly Found In	Example Sentence
Expository	To explain, inform, or clarify a topic with facts.	- Objective and fact-based. - Does not include personal opinions. - Uses definitions, explanations, and logical structures.	Textbooks, instructional guides, news articles, academic papers.	"Photosynthesis is the process by which green plants convert sunlight into energy, essential for maintaining ecological balance."

Critical Tone – Explanation :

A critical tone is used when the author evaluates or critiques a subject by pointing out its strengths and weaknesses. This tone is often analytical and may highlight flaws, inconsistencies, or areas that need improvement. It is commonly found in reviews, opinion pieces, academic essays, and editorial articles. While a critical tone may be negative, it is not necessarily harsh—it can also be balanced and constructive.

analytical 

Sample Passage :

The government's recent education policy, though ambitious in its vision, lacks clarity in execution. While it emphasizes digital learning and skill-based education, it fails to address the deep-rooted infrastructural challenges faced by rural schools. Many schools still struggle with inadequate resources, a shortage of qualified teachers, and unreliable internet access, making digital initiatives ineffective. Additionally, the policy's heavy focus on technology overlooks the importance of teacher-student interaction, which remains a crucial aspect of learning. Furthermore, the evaluation methods proposed are vague, raising concerns about how student progress will be accurately measured. Supporters argue that the policy represents a much-needed modernization of the education system, but without a clear implementation roadmap, its success remains uncertain. Instead of focusing solely on futuristic reforms, the government must first strengthen the foundation of existing educational institutions. A well-structured execution plan is essential for the policy to bring meaningful change.



Practice Passages and Questions



Topic : Practice Passage



Read the following passage and answer the given question.

Iguacu Falls, which sit on the border between Argentina and Brazil, are said to make Niagara look like a leaky faucet. The great cataracts stretch for two and a half miles across lushly foliated rocky outcroppings before plunging a staggering two hundred and thirty feet into the river below.

The falls region is densely forested, and is home to a wide variety of plants and animals, including a number of endangered ones. It is a paradise where parrots dive and swoop through the spray, butterflies cavort among the tropical plants and coatis, and giant otters and anteaters amble through the trees. The foliage itself varies between tropical and deciduous with orchids blushing in the shade of pines and ferns nodding gracefully in the shadow of fruit trees.

Question - 01



#Q. The author's attitude toward Iguacu Falls can best be described as which of the following ?

A. Overweening pride.

B. Positive appreciation.

~~C.~~ Mild acceptance.

D. Apathetic objectivity.

y

+ve



Topic : Practice Passage



Read the following passage and answer the given questions.

At the heart of the enormous boom in wine consumption that has taken place in the English speaking world over the last two decades or so is a fascinating, happy paradox. In the days when wine was exclusively the preserve of a narrow cultural elite, bought either at auctions or from gentleman wine merchants in wing collars and bow-ties, to be stored in rambling cellars and decanted to order by one's butler, the ordinary the drinker didn't get a look-in. Wine was considered a highly technical subject, in which anybody without the necessary ability could only fall flat on his or her face in embarrassment. It wasn't just that you needed a refined aesthetic sensibility for the stuff if it wasn't to be hopelessly wasted on you. It required an intimate knowledge of what came from where, and what it was supposed to taste like.

W C ↑ (Ging)
elite
exclusi
tech

Those were times, however, when wine appreciation essentially meant a familiarity with the great French classics, with perhaps a smattering of other wines — like sherry and port. That was what the wine trade dealt in. These days, wine is bought daily in supermarkets and high-street chains to be consumed in the evening, hardly anybody has a cellar to store it in and most don't even possess a decanter. Above all, the wines of literally dozens of countries are available in our market. When a supermarket offers its customers a couple of fruity little numbers from Brazil, we scarcely raise an eyebrow.

Wine app.
French
classics

Reach⁺

It seems, in other words, that the commercial jungle that wine has now become has not in the slightest deterred people from plunging adventurously into the thickets in order to taste and see. Consumers are no longer intimidated by the thought of needing to know their Pouilly-Fume from their Pouilly- Fuisse, just at the very moment when there is more to know than ever before.

Consumer



The reason for this new mood of confidence is not hard to find. It is on every wine label from Australia, New Zealand, South Africa and the United States : the name of the grape from which the wine is made. At one time that might have sounded like a fairly technical approach in itself. Why should native English-speakers know what Cabernet Sauvignon or Chardonnay were? The answer lies in the popularity that wines made from those grape varieties now enjoy. Consumers effectively recognize them as brand names, and have acquired a basic lexicon of wine that can serve them even when confronted with those Brazilian upstarts.

Reason

Composition
Label

→ dictionary

In the wine heartlands of France, they are scared to death of that trend—not because they think their wine isn't as good as the best from California or South Australia (what French winemaker will ever admit that?) but because they don't traditionally call their wines Cabernet Sauvignon or Chardonnay. They call them Château Ducru Beaucaillou or Corton-Charlemagne, and they aren't about to change. Some areas, in the middle of southern France, have now produced a generation of growers using the varietal names on their labels and are tempting consumers back to French wine. It will be an uphill struggle, but there is probably no other way if France is to avoid simply becoming a specialty source of old-fashioned wines for old-fashioned connoisseurs.



Wine consumption was also given a significant boost in the early 1990s by the work of Dr. Serge Renaud, who has spent many years investigating the reasons for the uncannily low incidence of coronary heart disease in the south of France. One of his major findings is that the fat-derived cholesterol that builds up in the arteries and can eventually lead to heart trouble, can be dispersed by the tannins in wine. Tannin is derived from the skins of grapes, and is therefore present in higher levels in red wines, because they have to be infused with their skins to attain the red colour. That news caused a huge upsurge in red wine consumption in the United States. It has not been accorded the prominence it deserves in the UK, largely because the medical profession still sees all alcohol as a menace to health, and is constantly calling for it will be made prohibitively expensive. Certainly, the manufacturers of anticoagulant drugs might have something to lose if we all got the message that we would do just as well by our hearts by taking half a bottle of red wine every day!

Dr. SR

Tannin

US wine consumption

UK ↓ ?

Question - 02



#Q. The tone that the author uses while asking “what French winemaker will ever admit that?” is best described as :

- A. Caustic — *ve*
- B. Satirical ✓
- C. Critical — *ve*
- D. Hypocritical *x*

Question - 03



#Q. What according to the author should the French do to avoid becoming a producer of merely old-fashioned wines ?

- A. Follow the labeling strategy of the English-speaking countries
- B. Give their wines English names
- C. Introduce fruity wines as Brazil has done
- D. Produce the wines that have become popular in the English-speaking world

Question - 04



#Q. The development which has created fear among winemakers in the wine heartland of France is the :

- A. ^{HB} Tendency not to name wines after the grape varieties that are used in the wines.
- B. 'Education' that consumers have derived from wine labels from English speaking countries.
- C. New generation of local winegrowers who use labels that show names of grape varieties.
- D. Ability of consumers to understand a wine's qualities when confronted with "Brazilian upstarts".

Concepts + Mock?

Test taking

Yomun — IRCT-2V1A



2 Min Summary



- 1) Strategies to Solve Tone and Structure Questions
- 2) Practice Passage
- 3) Practice Questions



*Thank
You*